

Code of Ethics for NBE's Employees and Senior Management



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01

Our Values

- **Responsibility & Commitment:** To acknowledge that we are responsible for our words and actions and committed to comply with all work regulations.
- **Teamwork:** To collaborate and cooperate in order to achieve our goals.
- **Professionalism:** To always act professionally and adeptly in order to serve our customers and the society.
- **Integrity:** To always work according to our values, even if this comes against our self-interest.

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Introduction

- The success of any bank in achieving its goals depends ultimately on its customers' trust. Employees are, indeed, the basis of such confidence. It is essential that employees show commitment ; maintain confidentiality, honesty, and objectivity; and comply with the legal and regulatory requirements. The banking industry is based on professional ethics and behaviors that are rooted in society. A bank employee should act as a role model for integrity and ethical behavior, and should refrain from suspicious actions or taking undue advantage of his/her job.
- The National Bank of Egypt (NBE) is keen on providing a positive work environment that encourages employees to achieve their maximum potential. By maintaining the highest standards of ethical and professional behavior and fostering a culture of respect and shared responsibility. Constructive cooperation and fair competition among banks are essential for a healthy banking environment, which should be practiced with a sense of honor while avoiding any practices that may adversely affect the best interest of the banking sector. Due to the sensitive nature of the banking industry, an employee should not leverage their position to attain personal gains, or accept any kind of reward from customers for performing their regular duties. Any violation by an employee shall be properly handled first by the Bank's internal investigations, subject to the approval of senior management, before being referred to external entities.
- The Code of Ethics (COE) serves to establish a framework of sound behavioral, ethical, and professional standards, values, and principles to which all employees and chief officers should adhere. In this context, chief officers refer to the Chairman, the Chief Executive Officer (CEO), board directors, and other executives responsible for executive, supportive, and regulatory divisions.

COE's Approval and Application

The COE is approved by the Board of Directors and is applicable to all NBE employees, including those in subsidiaries, representative offices, and overseas branches, unless there are specific, separately approved policies, in accordance with the relevant regulations.

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Responsibility of Chief Officers and Employees

Chief officers must ensure the effective management of all the Bank's activities within their scope of responsibility through the following:

- Ensuring impartial performance appraisal for their employees, monitoring their performance, and developing their skills and capacities to help them sustain and excel at their jobs.
- A chief officer who becomes aware of, or receives information about, an employee's violation of the COE must not harbor the employee and must conduct a thorough investigation with the employee or the relevant work group to take the appropriate action.
- Encouraging employees to comply with the Conflict of Interest Management Policy and the Whistleblowing and Whistleblower Protection Policy and reporting any such incidents. No negative action should be taken against any employee upon reporting any illegal practices, as long as reporting is made in accordance with the internal regulations.
- Informing the employees of the Gift Acceptance Policy, and encouraging their strict adherence.
- Raising the employees' awareness with respect to media interactions, social media networks, and cybersecurity policies.



- Employees should refrain from any religious or political discussions within the workplace, during official working hours, or through any representation of the Bank.
- All employees should protect the Bank's assets and property.
- Ensuring accuracy before making any disclosure to the Central Bank of Egypt (CBE) of any critical information or data falling within their scope of work to the Central Bank of Egypt (CBE). Such disclosure, if any, must be made in a thorough and timely manner, and in accordance with the applicable instructions.
- In case of assigning specific tasks to third parties, ensure their efficiency, follow up the proper performance of the assigned tasks within the agreed timeframe, and take the necessary action in case of failure, in compliance with the approved policies in this regard.

Responsibility of Employees:

- Honesty, integrity, and adherence to the applicable laws and regulations, as well as the Bank's policies.
- Efficiency, accuracy, and proficiency.
- Observe transparency and honesty with stakeholders and manage conflicts of interest.
- Maintain confidentiality of information, data, and the Bank's property.
- Prohibit inadmissible practices in the workplace.
- Comply with the Gift Acceptance Policy.
- Adhere to the AML, CFT, and Anti-Fraud Policy.
- Report violations and illegal practices.

The COE reflects our commitment to integrity in all aspects of our business, and it serves as an essential tool to ensure that decisions align with organizational aspirations.
"Excellence, Every Day."

When there is a suspicious action, just ask yourself the following questions:

- ❖ Is this action legal?
- ❖ Does it comply with the COE?
- ❖ Does it conform to the applicable policies and instructions?
- ❖ Is this action justifiable to your manager?



If your answer is “Yes”, you have to abide by the relevant instructions and decisions.



If your answer is “No” or “I do not know”, you have to report the action to the line manager and/or Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group.

NBE's COE for Employees and Senior Management is a general framework for the work process regulations and policies applicable at NBE. It is the responsibility of each and every employee who has read this COE to fully abide by its entire contents. Failure to comply with the instructions stated in the COE or the provisions stated in the employment contract and undertakings signed by employees upon their recruitment or throughout their employment period at the Bank, whether in writing or by confirmation on Oracle, subjects the non-compliant employee to investigation and/or civil, criminal, administrative, or disciplinary penalties in accordance with the applicable laws and the Bank's regulations of disciplinary penalties.

Interpretation of NBE's Code of Ethics Provisions

Any code of ethics does not attempt to list all the situations to which an employee may be exposed. Hence, the Bank relies on its employees and senior management to exercise enhanced due care and diligence, maintain objectivity in their judgment, and in case of having any questions or concerns, immediately contact the Ethics Department at the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group through:

Ethical_officer@nbe.com.eg



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Work Environment

Efficiency, Accuracy and Proficiency

Employees should carry out all duties at their best and pay due diligence and care to performing their duties and responsibilities efficiently and accurately, putting in their best endeavors. Each and every employee must act with honesty, responsibility, integrity, and proficiency at all times, in a manner that serves the interests of the Bank and its customers in particular, and the banking sector in general, and in line with the ethical behavior that is reflected in customer trust.

Occupational Health and Safety

All employees shall follow NBE-issued occupational safety and health instructions and measures.

Employee Behaviors

-  Show respect to coworkers and superiors, and conduct oneself professionally.
-  Respect and utilize working hours to perform work duties.
-  Refrain from any inappropriate behavior or quarrels, and respect the privacy of others.
-  Ensure that all the documents that may contain confidential data or information are secure before leaving the workplace.
-  Comply with all the provisions of NBE's Code of Ethics.
-  Maintain a sober appearance, whether inside or outside the Bank, during the performance of work duties and abide by the dress code.
-  Refrain from publishing or sharing any internal information and/or work obstacles with any third party by any means or on social media.

Employee Behaviors

-  Ensure not to provide false and/or misleading information to the customers, the Bank, or the CBE.
-  Must not record phone calls, take photos, or film videos of any nature of other persons without their knowledge and consent, nor share such material. If any employee threatens to disclose or share any material obtained by eavesdropping, recording, taking pictures, or filming videos, such employee shall be subject to disciplinary actions and will be reported to the competent legal authorities.

Employees' Professional Duties

All employees shall perform their duties effectively and efficiently in accordance with laws, policies, internal work procedures, and this Code of Ethics.

In addition, all NBE employees representing the Bank abroad, as well as any employees assigned with a domestic or foreign mission, are expected to observe the following:

1. Behave properly in general everywhere, as the employee is a representative of NBE;
2. Follow the applicable laws, regulations, and rules of the country;
3. Respect the customs and traditions of other countries to which s/he is missioned;
4. Maintain a professional appearance;
5. Contact the competent officer at NBE to resolve problems in case of any emergencies; and
6. Coordinate with colleagues and line manager regarding tasks assigned to the employee at the Bank in case of traveling on missions.

Training

Training is essential for the development of employees' competencies and skills, so all employees should attend the mandatory training programs selected by NBE during the period determined by the Bank.

No Racial Discrimination or Harassment

An appropriate and equitable work environment should be provided. There should be no discrimination among employees (whether based on gender, color, religion, age, health condition, family history, personal appearance, etc.). Employees should have no fear of being subjected to injustice in all its forms. Harassment and mistreatment, whether direct or indirect, by various managerial levels are not acceptable.

All forms of abuse are prohibited, including verbal, moral, and physical harassment or threat, as well as any ethically impermissible practices. This also includes harassment as defined in the Labor Law, i.e. any act or behavior in or in connection with the workplace that constitutes sexual or indecent exposure to others by gestures, words, deeds, or any other means, including wired, wireless, electronic, or any other technological means. The Code of Ethics also prohibits bullying as defined in the Labor Law, i.e. any act or behavior in or in connection with the workplace, whether by words, show of force or control, or exploitation of a weakness or condition believed by the perpetrator to be offensive to others, based on gender, race, religion, physical attributes, health or mental condition, or social status, with the intent to intimidate, ridicule, demean, or exclude them from their social environment, using any means, including wired, wireless, electronic, or any other technological means. In case an employee experiences unfair or discriminatory treatment or harassment, s/he should promptly inform NBE's ethics officer. Any employee who commits an indecent conduct at the workplace shall be punished by employment termination.

Drugs and Alcohol Prohibition

All NBE employees shall not use, consume, sell, distribute, or deal in alcoholic drinks by any means inside the Bank's premises and facilities or during working hours. It is a violation of NBE's policy for any staff member to be present in his/her workplace or to perform his/her work while being under the influence of alcohol. All employees are also prohibited from using or dealing with illegal drugs or unauthorized substances by any means inside or outside the Bank's premises and facilities. In case of infringement, disciplinary actions shall be taken according to the Bank's regulations/policy of disciplinary penalties, and the matter will be referred to the relevant authorities on a case by case basis. Any employee found drunk or under the influence of drugs during working hours and/or inside the Bank's premises shall be punished by employment termination. The Bank may carry out routine or random drug tests for employees without prior notice at the discretion of the Bank's competent officials. The employee may also be subject to alcohol testing if found drunk during performing his/her job to prove his/her condition.

Social Media Networks:



Social media has grown tremendously in the last few years, radically influencing personal relationships. It also led to creating virtual communities and increasing online interactions. In order to protect NBE's reputation, only the relevant divisions may reply to all customer comments and inquiries.



Employees must ensure that no information (whether for internal use only, confidential, or strictly confidential) is shared upon joining any group on social media.



No employee may join a group administered by an unknown person, because such group may include members outside the Bank who may seek access to the Bank's insider information.



No employee may publish or share any information related to the Bank or its employees (policies, work procedures internal correspondence, and/or decisions) through external means. Any offence against NBE or the banking sector, or their respective employees or management, on any website and/or social media platform is strictly prohibited. No personal opinions may be expressed as representing the Bank's opinions.



No inquiry about, or response to any inquiry about, the Bank's internal procedures or the employees' benefits may be expressed on social media, and any incidence of this sort shall be deemed a disclosure of the Bank's insider information.



No pictures or videos taken inside NBE's premises may be published by employees online..



Any employee who violates the above-mentioned instructions shall be subject to strict disciplinary actions according to the Bank's regulations/policies of disciplinary penalties.

Gift Acceptance

Employees may not solicit or accept any gift, invitation, or service, for themselves or for any of their relatives, if it would impair their objectivity in performing their duties, influence their work decisions, or could be interpreted as implying an obligation in return. The value and timing of the gift or hospitality should also be considered.

If refusing a gift might affect the third party's relationship with the Bank or cause offense to the gift giver, it may be accepted, provided the below gift acceptance controls are adhered to. All employees should not be involved in any situation in which such gifts may affect work decisions, and they shall comply with the Gift Acceptance Policy. In all cases, gifts shall be within normal criteria of courtesy and shall not have adverse effect on the Bank's reputation.

Monetary gifts (cash/gift cards/precious stones/gold/silver) may not be accepted from third parties (banks/government entities/customers/vendors) for any reason. It is also prohibited for NBE employees to pursue their self-interest or accept favors from third parties for performing customary tasks within their ordinary course of work.

Related policies: Gift Acceptance Policy

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Gift acceptance from customers, vendors, or third parties (continued)

Maximum limit of acceptable gifts from third parties:

For Employees up to Deputy General Manager	For General Managers and Group Heads	For Higher Positions
The maximum limit for accepting gifts is EGP 5,000. The employee receiving the gift should fill in the “Gift Acceptance” Form, which must be undersigned by his/her line manager, and provide one copy for the Ethics Department and another copy for the Compensation and Benefits Division.	The maximum limit for accepting gifts is EGP 7,500. The employee receiving the gift should fill in the “Gift Acceptance” Form, which must be undersigned by his/her line manager, and provide one copy for the Ethics Department and another copy for the Compensation and Benefits Division.	The maximum limit for accepting gifts is EGP 10,000. The employee receiving the gift should fill in the “Gift Acceptance” Form, which must be undersigned by his/her line manager, and provide one copy for the Ethics Department and another copy for the Compensation and Benefits Division.

In case the value of the gift exceeds the above-mentioned maximum limit, the employee receiving the gift must fill in the “Gift Acceptance” Form, which must be undersigned by his/her line manager, and provide one copy for the Ethics Department and another copy for the Compensation and Benefits Division to which the gift shall be delivered.

In case of suspecting the value of the presented in-kind gifts, the employee receiving the gift shall fill in the “Gift Acceptance” Form, which must be undersigned by his/her line manager, and submit the form to the Logistics Supply Division at the Administrative Support Group to determine the value of the gift. Gifts in excess of the stated maximum limits are submitted to the Compensation and Benefits Division – HR Group to be used as part of NBE's employee motivation policy.

Related Policies: Gift Acceptance Policy

Employees' Complaints

NBE provides employees with a mechanism for reporting work-related complaints while maintaining the privacy and confidentiality of employees and objectivity in dealing with such complaints. Complaints should be genuine and should not be submitted by the employee unless all reasonable attempts to resolve the issue with the line manager or the relevant department have been exhausted.



Employees should comply with NBE's Employee Complaints Policy and procedures issued by the HR Group. Any employee who raises allegations with bad intentions or to cause damage or seek personal gains will be subject to disciplinary actions according to the regulations/policies of disciplinary penalties.



Related Policies: Escalation, Complaints, and Grievances Policy

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Dealing with Related Parties

Co-workers and managers:

- Employees should keep up team spirit, which ensures mutual respect and cooperation while performing duties, and uphold the highest standards of proficiency, transparency, and integrity. Employees should also respect the privacy and opinions of others, and refrain from any unethical practices.
- Employees should cooperate with and assist managers to best serve public interest. This involves the timely performance of assigned tasks with the required efficiency, without violating the employment contract, laws, regulations, and public morals. Employees should generally adopt development plans created by their managers to enhance their skills and professional experience.
- Managers should treat subordinates impartially and not discriminate against any employee except on the basis of competence. Managers should not assign any tasks to subordinates in violation of laws, instructions, internal policies, and work procedures or mandate them to perform personal tasks.

Dealing with Related Parties

Stakeholders

Employees should observe transparency and credibility and provide advice and accurate information to stakeholders (e.g. auditors, vendors, any third party, etc.) while adhering to the Bank's internal policies regarding conflict of interest.

CBE

Employees should consider disclosure, transparency, and credibility when making information and data available to the CBE. They must not present any inaccurate or misleading information or data, nor conceal any information. Communication with the CBE must be conducted solely by the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group and/or the authorized divisions.

05

Compliance with Laws and Regulatory Requirements

NBE, as a financial institution providing banking services in different jurisdictions, is subject to various local and international legal and regulatory requirements. Therefore, all NBE employees have to:



Abide by all laws, regulatory requirements, guidelines, as well as the policies and procedures governing NBE.



Promptly report any breaches to laws and regulatory instructions to the line manager or compliance officer at the relevant branch/department, the compliance officer at the Head Office, or the Ethics Officer.



AML and CFT

Financial Crimes:

NBE complies with all international laws, legislation, and standards, including combating financial crimes legislation and instructions issued by local legislators, supervising authorities, and regulators at the jurisdictions in which the Bank operates. NBE also follows the Financial Action Task Force's (FATF) recommendations regarding anti-money laundering (AML), combating financing of terrorism (CFT), and the proliferation of weapons of mass destruction.

Related policies: KYC Guide

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Compliance by NBE with AML and CFT laws and legislation is the responsibility of all employees. Accordingly, all employees shall:

-  Abide by all relevant laws and instructions issued by the CBE and the AML/CFT Unit, as well as NBE's internal policies.
-  Exercise due diligence to determine the true identity of customers, the purpose of their transactions, and how far they align with the nature of their business and income in application of KYC regulations.
-  Identify "red flags", such as corruption indicators and other money laundering and terrorism financing indicators, and avoid involvement in any money laundering or terrorist financing activities, transactions, or crimes.
-  Take the necessary procedures upon detecting any unusual or suspicious activities or transactions that may involve money laundering or terrorist financing by reporting them to the compliance officer at the relevant branch/department or at the Head Office.
-  Employees may not disclose to any customer or payee any information related to the Bank's internal procedures, nor make any direct or indirect practices that would assist customers to conceal any identification information or evade taxes.

Related Policies: KYC Guide

Cryptocurrency

Cryptocurrency is an electronically stored currency that is not denominated in any currency issued by an official issuing authority and is traded online. Issuing, trading in, or promoting cryptocurrencies or digital money; creating or operating platforms for trading in the same; or carrying out related activities is prohibited without obtaining a license from the CBE's board of directors pursuant to the rules and procedures under Article 206 of the Central Bank Law No. 194 of 2020.

Committing any of the stated acts is a violation of the Code of Ethics for Employees and Senior Management. The violator will be subject to punishment according to the provisions of Article 225 of the aforementioned Central Bank Law whereby the violator shall be liable to “imprisonment and/or a fine of no less than one million Egyptian pounds and not exceeding ten million Egyptian pounds”.

Preventing Fraud



Employees must adhere to the highest standards of integrity and refrain completely from engaging in any fraudulent, unethical, or illegal practices that may harm the Bank, its customers, or third parties, including, but not limited to, falsifying or counterfeiting documents.



Employees must immediately report any actual or potential fraud to the Bank's competent departments once any reasonably suspected case arises.



NBE immediately notifies the CBE's Fraud Combating Central Department (FCCD) of all fraud cases once detected, in accordance with the mechanism determined by the CBE in this regard, and ensures that all relevant information is collected, documented, and handled with strict confidentiality.

Combating Bribery and Corruption

NBE strictly prohibits any form of bribery, gratuities, any sums of money, or undue benefits subject to the Gift Acceptance Policy. NBE also prohibits engaging in the facilitation of or being aware of any of the abovementioned acts without reporting the same to the compliance officer at the Head Office. Employees may not offer or give any gifts, bribes, donations, or discounts; waive any fees, charges, or commission due to the Bank; provide any special privileges, services, or anything of that sort in violation of the instructions or controls as per the authorities and powers determined by the Bank, or offer gifts of value (directly or indirectly) to any third party for the purpose of facilitating or streamlining any operations related to NBE.

Employees may not, directly or indirectly, solicit any sum of money/ loan/ advance/ gift/ valuable item/ any type of preferential treatment, nor make use of their job to achieve personal purposes or interests.



Employees shall forthwith report to the compliance officer at the Head Office any actual or suspected attempt of soliciting bribes or gratuities or any act of corruption.



Related Policies: Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy

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Consumer Protection

All employees must comply with the Consumer Protection Instructions issued by the CBE.

Employees may not exercise any of the following practices, including without limitation:



Providing inaccurate or incomplete information to any customer regarding any banking products or services, or failing to notify the customer of any material information that may adversely affect his/her transactions or financial position, including the non-disclosure of the details of fees and commissions of such products.



Giving customers unsound recommendations in relation to their transactions, or executing transactions without assessing the risks to which the customer may be exposed as a result of that.



Enticing customers to obtain banking products that are not suitable for them to generate profits for the bank and prioritizing personal interests over customers' needs and interests.



Delay or failure in responding properly to customers' complaints as per the applicable internal processes.



Related Policies: Banking Consumer Protection Policy

Cybersecurity

Employees shall be fully aware and continuously compliant with cybersecurity policies and procedures.

There are general instructions for classifying and sharing information according to the Cybersecurity Policy. In case of having any doubts or concerns regarding the confidentiality classification of any information, such data or information may not be disclosed to anyone before referring to the compliance officer at the Head Office or to the Cybersecurity Division.

An employee is responsible for keeping his/her password and may not share it with others.

Information security is a mission and a responsibility to be shared among all NBE staff.

Attention

An employee shall not deal with e-mails of unknown source and report such e-mails to the cybersecurity team.

No employee shall ever disclose any personal information, e-mail, password, or information related to credit cards or accounts to any external e-mail of unknown source.



The Bank's information, such as customers' information and internal policies, may not be shared on artificial intelligence (AI) websites such as ChatGPT.



06

Protecting NBE's and Customers' Data

Information Confidentiality

Enhancing NBE's ability to accomplish its objectives starts with keeping the confidentiality of the information held in its possession. The Bank's policy is to safeguard such information against any breach, theft, falsification, or misuse whether internally or externally.

Employees shall protect data and information, use them properly, and maintain the customer and account information contained in NBE's systems/ programs/ documents according to the banking secrecy articles stipulated in Law No. 194 of 2020 on the Central Bank and Banking System.

Information Confidentiality

Some information (such as allowances, compensations, and appraisals) may be announced and well-known to all employees inside the Bank; however, it is considered confidential. Accordingly, all employees must be very careful not to discuss such information with unauthorized employees or anyone outside the Bank, such as friends, relatives, or acquaintances whether inside or outside the banking sector.

Customer information and account data are subject to special legal protection and shall not be accessible by third parties unless employees are authorized to do so subject to a written approval obtained from the relevant customers or in operation of an exception stated by law.

Disclosure of any information related to work or customers to any unauthorized employees or anyone outside the Bank may be punishable by dismissal, in addition to the civil, criminal, or administrative penalties in accordance with the applicable laws.

Information and data accessible to employees shall be kept confidential and shall not be disclosed. Furthermore, the confidentiality of any of the Bank's documents, whether in relation to the Bank's activities, employees, or customers, shall be maintained and treated with strict confidentiality. In case of disclosure of any of such information or data other than legally permissible, the necessary disciplinary actions shall be taken according to the Bank's regulations/policy of disciplinary penalties. Any information classified as "for internal use only, confidential, or strictly confidential" may only be handled by the relevant employees inside the Bank, and shall not be discussed with friends or family members. In addition, employees may not keep a copy of any of the Bank's documents/ correspondence outside the Bank's premises/devices.

Handling Insider Information and Maintaining the Confidentiality of Information and Data



Employees shall not misuse any insider information or leak any information that may not be shared in order to achieve any direct or indirect personal interest, whether inside or outside the Bank. This shall apply during and after the period of employment. It should always be remembered that damage resulting from disclosure could start with giving a hint or an indirect reference to confidential matters or leaking a seemingly insignificant piece of information.



Information Classification



Public

Any information that is intended for internal or external use, the disclosure of which does not affect the Bank,

including, but not limited to, information available on NBE's website.



Internal use only

Any information intended to be shared within the Bank only and which may result in damage to NBE if accessed by unauthorized persons,

including, but not limited to, NBE's internal policies.



Confidential

Any information that requires authorization to be accessed or handled subject to certain rules by any recipient, whether inside or outside the Bank,

including, but not limited to, customer information and the employees' personal information.



Strictly confidential

Any information that requires the highest level of confidentiality. Any unauthorized disclosure of such information may have a material adverse effect on the Bank's interest,

including, but not limited to, product plans before launching, marketing plans before being announced, and acquisition/merger plans.

Requests for Data and Information

- It shall be verified that the approval of the relevant divisions is obtained upon requesting the completion of any questionnaires that may involve disclosing any information related to the Bank by third parties.
- The Bank may block the account of a customer pursuant to the decisions of judicial or regulatory bodies or the CBE. Such procedure shall be taken in compliance with the relevant applicable laws. Despite bank account secrecy and the confidentiality of information held by NBE, the Bank shall report any suspicious money laundering transactions or disclose any bank account information pursuant to an order or decision by said entities to block the accounts of some customers. The Bank may also take this procedure for the purpose of protecting its own assets and property.
- No employee may inform a customer of any request made by a regulatory body to investigate his/her accounts or inform the customer of the reason for blocking his/her account, except in case of administrative or judicial attachments in favor of the Egyptian Tax Authority or the National Organization for Social Insurance or in execution of a judgment where customers are already informed of such a decision.

Post-Employment Obligations (Resigned and Retired Employees):

Certain obligations that arise in the course of the employees' employment shall survive the termination of their employment at NBE (including termination due to retirement). Obligations that remain effective after the termination of employment include returning all the Bank's property that may be in their possession to the Bank and maintaining the confidentiality of the information and data of NBE and NBE's customers, vendors, business partners, and former employees.

Public Statements and Announcements



Any communication with the media (whether printed, visual, electronic, or on social media platforms) must be done through the Marketing and Social Development Group. In addition, no employee may act in the name of the Bank without an authorization to do so.



The Marketing and Social Development Group's approval must be obtained regarding any letters, interviews in different media, presentations, or the participation of any NBE employee in any event related to the Bank's business, including advertisements, promotional campaigns, taking photos of NBE's facilities and buildings, and sponsorship arrangements. The relevant policies and procedures shall apply. Any requests or communications for making public statements received by any employee must be reported to the Marketing and Social Development Group via e-mail: Marketing&social_development_group@nbe.com.eg



Each employee should know that s/he speaks in her/his own name not for NBE. Unless authorized, employees shall not give the impression that their opinions or acts express NBE's policies, opinions, or tendencies.

07

Protecting NBE's Assets

All employees shall protect NBE's fixed and current assets and shall neither misuse them, nor use them for unauthorized purposes. In addition, any new or innovative products with the Bank may not be used or benefited from for personal purposes. Such assets comprise the following (for example):

- Brand name and trade mark
- NBE's funds
- Electronic devices
- Buildings and furniture
- Systems and software
- NBE's documents

Use of NBE's Software, Devices, and Communication Means

In all cases, NBE's assets may only be used in the Bank's daily activities and not for any personal purposes. Communication means may be used for personal purposes only as follows, provided that the relevant line manager's approval is obtained.

Using the above shall be as follows:

- 1- Making infrequent short calls.
- 2- For uses that do not incur high costs to the Bank due to long calls.
- 3- For uses that are not related to any illegal, religious or political activities or furthering personal interests.
- 4- Uses that should not negatively affect the performance of the employee or his/her colleagues.
- 5- For urgent personal matters.

Any negligence in maintaining the Bank's funds or property or items held with the Bank for the account of its customers, resulting in potential damage or loss, may be punishable by dismissal.

Intellectual Property

Any intellectual property acquired in the course of the employee's employment shall be the sole property of the Bank. All technologies, products, or services used or developed by any employee in the course of his/her employment period are the sole property of the Bank. Any ideas obtained by an employee may not be disclosed in any way to any other institution for implementation or use.

08

Accounting Systems and Security and Safety of Banking Transactions

NBE's accounting system is designed to record and maintain the Bank's accounting entries, and ensure accurate and sound accounting procedures. All NBE's accounting and financial transactions must be carried out in accordance with the Bank's applicable procedures as per the relevant policies, circulars, and generally accepted accounting practices. The Bank's records and accounts must accurately and precisely reflect such accounting and financial transactions.

Accounting Systems and Security and Safety of Banking Transactions



NBE's assets and liabilities shall be correctly and accurately recorded in line with international accounting standards and supported with documents.



All employees shall at all times present accurate and correct information to any decision makers at the Bank. No employee may conceal or present any data/ statistics by way of fraud, which may adversely affect the Bank's decision makers, or conceal facts upon being presented to any employee, or any senior or oversight division.

Each employee is required to promptly notify the compliance officer at the Head Office, in case s/he is asked to record or document any operations or transactions of NBE in such a manner that misrepresents or conceals their true nature, timing, or any other detail, or in case it comes to his/her knowledge that any other employee(s) is (are) committing such act.



The Bank shall not recognize any payments made on behalf of the Bank, its customers, or its affiliates based on intentions or orally communicated instructions. Payments shall only be made for purposes supported by documents.



Financial Reporting

All the necessary actions shall be taken upon preparing NBE's periodic reports to ensure the production of adequate, appropriate, and accurate reports in accordance with international accounting standards and NBE-internal rules and processes. NBE employees should abide by the predetermined reporting dates for both periodic and extraordinary reports. Such reports should be provided in a timely manner, and on a prompt basis, to give the senior management and auditors enough time to review, assess, and verify the relevant data, documents, and reports before being announced.

Book-Keeping at NBE

All NBE employees are responsible for keeping/destroying the Bank's documents pursuant to the applicable regulations and authority in this respect, as per the retention period of each individual document or file pertaining to each banking transaction, which is determined by the Bank's relevant instructions (i.e. the retention period of tax files, prior to destroying, differs from that of credit files or journals). Suspected breach of such instructions or any attempt to destroy any of the Bank's documents by an employee in violation of the applicable instructions shall be reported to NBE's compliance officer.

All Bank documents that are no longer valid or required, such as expired computer-generated documents and approvals, must be destroyed and shall not be used outside the Bank in any manner whatsoever as per the relevant instructions.

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Conflict of Interest

Conflict of interest is the case in which an employee or a related family member has a tangible or intangible interest that contradicts the requirements of his/her position or job in terms of integrity, impartiality, and safeguarding public funds, or is deemed a reason for illicit gain for himself/herself or for third parties. In case a conflict of interest exists, the employee must inform the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group of such conflict and take the necessary procedures to protect the Bank and its rights. .

Conflict of interest occurs when the interest of the Bank and that of the employee are contradictory. Conflict of interest is evident when an employee takes actions that would benefit him/her or any related family member or when s/he uses her/ his position at the Bank to provide undue advantages to a friend(s) or a relative(s), such as granting loans or offering discounted fees and commissions that are not available to other customers, or discloses the Bank's shareholdings in companies of which the Bank is a shareholder, in violation of the relevant applicable instructions and regulations.

NBE's employees shall avoid any suspicious conflict of interest and report the same to the Ethics Department at the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group.



Borrowing and Advances



NBE's employees are prohibited from lending/borrowing any amounts of money to/from colleagues, third parties (i.e. existing customers/vendors), or any NBE-related third parties. This applies to personal advances and not borrowing from other banks.



Concluding Contracts and Transactions with Third Parties



An employee or relative up to second degree may, directly or indirectly, purchase, sell, or lease any property in favor of the Bank or provide outsourcing services or supply requirements to the Bank only upon notifying the Regulatory Compliance & Corporate Governance Group, and provided that there is no conflict of interest that may directly benefit the employee, and that such transaction would benefit the Bank and is fairly conducted.



The Bank's policies and regulations governing the auctions offered by the Bank shall be adhered to.



Staff Banking Transactions

Banking Transactions

The Bank's employees may not process orders/transactions on their personal accounts or their relatives' accounts through the Bank's systems directly, even if the nature of their work allows them to do so, including making transfers or any other transactions. All such transactions shall be executed by any other competent employee. For example, a teller debits his/her personal account from his/ her till or an employee in charge of remittances processes a personal remittance using his/her own secret code.

Powers of Attorney

NBE's employees are not allowed to issue/ accept any legal or bank powers of attorney to operate customers' accounts with the Bank, except for relatives up to the second degree, provided that the approval of Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group is obtained before issuing powers of attorney.

Transactions Benefiting any NBE Employee or any Relative or Friend of an Employee

NBE's employees shall not be involved in any collateral, evaluation, or approval processes in respect of any loans or transactions of a similar nature between NBE and their relatives (by blood or affinity) or friends.

Staff Accounts

Employees shall not misuse their personal accounts. The purpose of staff accounts is to credit monthly salaries and to perform customary personal transactions related to employees only. All types of personal accounts may not be used as intermediary accounts to perform transactions for the benefit of a third party. Also, it is prohibited to use the staff accounts in favor of any third party, i.e. making banking transactions (receiving deposits or remittances) in favor of other persons or for any other commercial purposes.

Employees' Investments in Stock Exchange

Employees may trade in securities in public offerings and may purchase and sell securities subject to the following controls:

Shares and Securities:

- 1- NBE employees who have access to insider information, during the course of discharging their job duties or due to the nature of their work, may not utilize such information in favor of themselves or a third party, or directly or indirectly disclose the same to any other person.
- 2- No employee may trade in securities if s/he has direct or indirect access to any relevant material information* and is aware that it is insider information not available to the public. The employee may not give access to such information to any other person unless such person proves his/her legal capacity authorizing him/her to do so.
- 3- No employee may tip off any material insider information** to any person, including family members, who may accordingly purchase or sell securities or share information with another person who may purchase and sell securities.
- 4- Employees are authorized to trade on the stock exchange. Disclosure is required in case of trading shares of companies where NBE holds a controlling stake
- 5- Employees at the Investments Group and Treasury Group may trade on the stock exchange subject to obtaining the approval of the relevant Group Head (or his/her alternate) and notifying the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group, respectively.
- 6- Employees undertake to provide a statement of account from Misr for Central Clearing, Depository, and Registry (MCDR) if requested by the Bank.
- 7- Employees shall abide by the applicable laws and regulatory controls in that regard.

*Material information: means information that would have a tangible impact on the market value or trading of a security, the investment decisions taken by traders, or market trading trends.

**Insider information: means any material nonpublic information that is related to the business of a publicly traded company or a relevant party or entity.

Impartial Treatment of all Parties

All NBE employees shall treat all internal parties (i.e. co-workers, supervisors, and subordinates) and external parties (i.e. customers, vendors, and competitors) fairly and impartially.



No personal benefits or privileges may be unfairly obtained via the aforementioned parties through manipulation, concealment, deceit, or misuse of information and data accessed by them by reason of their positions in the Bank.



External Activities

Working for entities other than NBE

Employees are not allowed to work for external entities, become a board member of a company/ federation, act as a business partner, provide counselling services, act as self-employed, or have any secondary job in addition to their main job at the Bank, including any form of (paid or unpaid) part-time jobs, unless a prior written approval is obtained from the relevant Region/Group Head and the HR Group. The matter is then referred to the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group. The approval of the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) or his/her substitute must then be obtained, provided that such jobs do not contradict the duties assigned to the concerned employee at the Bank, subject to the relevant laws and regulations. In addition, employees may not enter into a partnership or a business relationship with any of the Bank's customers.

An employee may not engage in fraudulent marketing activities, such as a fraudulent investment scheme “pyramid scheme”, where individuals are promised to generate commission/return if they persuade other investors to make financial contributions for fund raising. Such scheme collapses when the pool of potential investors dries up. Furthermore, employees are prohibited from carrying out activities similar to the Bank's activities or engaging in any activity of a similar nature whether as a partner or an employee.



External Activities

Participation in political activities and social organizations

Employees wishing to act as board members or senior managers of non-profit/civil society organizations must obtain the approval of the relevant Region/Group Head and the HR Group, then the consent of the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group.



Employees may not engage in any religious, sectarian, or political discussions or meetings during working hours; circulate publications; collect signatures; or raise funds for any person or entity for any reason whatsoever, subject to the relevant staff regulations governing trade unions.



External Activities

Participation in political activities and social organizations (continued)

NBE's employees have the right to join any "legitimate" political parties or organizations. Any employee who wishes to participate in the political scene or join a given party must abide by the laws and legislation governing the relevant parties and social organizations and refrain from disrupting the public order in order to maintain the reputation and image of NBE's employees.

In addition, any employee who wishes to run for public office (e.g. membership of the parliament or municipal councils, NBE's Staff Syndicate, NBE's Staff Services Society, etc.) must abide by the following:

- 1- Refrain from using the Bank's logo while participating in the political scene or social organizations.
- 2- Refrain from using any of the Bank's systems, devices, or assets (e.g. NBE's e-mail system, internet, PCs, communication facilities, NBE's vehicles, etc.) in electoral campaigns.
- 3- Refrain from promising to facilitate certain procedures within NBE to influence voters in favor of a certain candidate.
- 4- Notify the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group.

These instructions shall remain in effect before, after, and during the electoral campaigns. In any case, NBE shall always be kept away from any propaganda in favor of one candidate over others. Any violations shall immediately be reported to the Ethics Department.

Using or exploiting NBE's brand name or logo for self interest



No employee may print any papers, documents, or promotional material (such as: diaries – calendars – pens – flash memory cards – stamps – etc.) or purchase any notebooks or printed material that carry the Bank's letterhead from a third party; only the relevant division in the Bank is authorized to do so.



No employee may use the Bank's logo for any reason beyond the scope of their work without first referring to the relevant divisions.



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Sustainability

Sustainability is one of NBE's strategic goals, aimed at sharpening the Bank's competitiveness to be a responsible and sustainable financial intermediary amid several global challenges, including climate change; hazardous environmental impacts; empowerment of women, youth, people with special needs, and micro-enterprises; and improvement of working conditions in terms of health, safety, and rights of customers and employees. Therefore, NBE's strategies and policies on sustainability and sustainable finance target creating added value for customers, employees, and society as a whole by taking into account the dimensions of environmental, economic, social, and governance sustainability in all of the Bank's activities.

- **Environmental dimension:** it considers the environmental risks of internal and finance activities, such as carbon emissions, waste disposal, and climate change.
- **Economic dimension:** it supports the transition to a sustainable economy, based on the expansion in fintech services and the use of renewable and clean energy.
- **Social dimension:** it aims at empowering women and youth, creating jobs, reducing poverty, and raising the living standards in areas most in need.
- **Governance dimension:** it promotes the rules through which the Bank is managed through using the environmental and social dimensions and integrating them with the strategies and policies to achieve a sustainable benefit for entrepreneurs and society as a whole.

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)

NBE believes in the necessity of participating in community development and service through community welfare programs. CSR lies at the heart of NBE's strategy, forming an integral part of the Bank's business model. NBE's policy reflects the methodology adopted to achieve its goals while ensuring commitment to sound CSR practices.

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Implementing the Code of Ethics and Reporting Violations

NBE believes that a healthy work environment is based on accountability and transparency. Accordingly, NBE encourages all employees to speak up immediately upon observing any violations or illegal practices. Reporting illegal practices is a collective responsibility aimed at protecting the Bank's reputation and fostering trust among colleagues and customers. There are various channels for reporting illegal practices and violations, including the relevant line manager, the Internal Audit and Inspection Group, the Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group, and the Ethics Department. Reports may be made with complete confidentiality, and the Bank prohibits any form of retaliation against whistleblowers.

Any employee who violates the abovementioned instructions shall be subject to strict disciplinary actions according to the Bank's approved regulations/policy of disciplinary penalties.

For more information on reporting procedures, please review the Whistleblowing and Whistleblower Protection Policy.

Code of Ethics Review

The Regulatory Compliance and Corporate Governance Group shall be responsible for regularly reviewing and updating the Code of Ethics for Employees and Senior Management biennially or when necessary, and for verifying its conformity with NBE's policies and procedures, as updated from time to time, as well as developments at the Bank.



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